

Siddharthan Sarumathi Pandian

Staff Engineer — 12+ years building scalable systems, leading high-impact teams, and shipping products used by 10M+ users.

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SKILLS

Tech: Node.js, React, PHP, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, Redis, Elasticsearch, Docker, AWS, GCP, Prometheus, CloudFormation, OpenTelemetry

Other: Software Architecture, Distributed Systems, System Design, AI-Assisted Development, Engineering Leadership & Coaching

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer (Contract) — Stripe Dec 2025 – Present

Operating at Staff scope as a solo contractor — owning cross-layer (infra, runtime, application) projects with no prior resolution path.

- Resolved a 14-month-old PHP-FPM/Bref broken pipe bug on AWS Lambda that had evaded multiple engineers, restoring availability SLO attainment from 41% to 99.99% via targeted vendor analysis and a zero-regression patch shipped upstream as an open-source PR.
- Led a zero-downtime migration of 250,000+ live Redis keys to ElastiCache (Valkey Serverless), implementing live replication via redis-shake to close the state-drift window before cutover — zero user logouts, zero downtime.
- Executed a PHP 8.1 → 8.4 upgrade across 2,500+ files with zero regressions, unblocking a year-long compatibility investigation and isolating the Lambda runtime as the root cause of availability degradation.
- Resolved high-severity bug bounty findings — including TOCTOU, IDOR, and CSRF vulnerabilities — through targeted security patches shipped to production.

Software Engineer & Interim Team Lead — Automattic Nov 2021 – Apr 2025

Automattic didn't use formal titles, but I operated in a Staff Engineer capacity across Jetpack and Calypso (closed-source codebase; merged PRs available on request).

- Led end-to-end development of Jetpack Social, integrating 7+ platforms (Bluesky, Facebook, Instagram, etc.) via a fault-tolerant scheduling system powering 3M+ daily shares.
- Designed a scalable encryption solution for 10M+ OAuth tokens following a Facebook security audit, eliminating token-related risk while sustaining sub-second read/write latency at scale.
- Modernized a 12-year-old codebase by building the Publicize Composer package, cutting duplicate code by 40%.
- Refactored the WordPress.com newsletter architecture, scaling subscribers from 60K to millions via Postgres performance tuning, queue optimization, and OpenTelemetry observability.
- Enforced rigorous PR review standards, catching 90% of critical bugs before they reached production.
- Led the team through the lead's sabbatical and drove a turnaround that reversed an 11-month MAU decline within 3 months — later offered the permanent Engineering Lead role after transitioning from peer to leader.

Technical Lead — Radius Agent *Apr 2018 – Oct 2021*

- Developed proprietary recommendation algorithms and in-house call center tooling (React, RabbitMQ, Twilio, Node.js, Golang, PHP) — saving \$10K/month, doubling deal closure rates, and streamlining referral processing.
- Built and operated end-to-end CI/CD pipelines and storage-backed microservices on AWS/GCP using Docker + Kubernetes, reducing manual ops to zero across 6+ production services.

Backend Engineer — Hashnode *Jan 2017 – Mar 2018*

- Built an end-to-end file storage and image optimization pipeline (S3, CloudFront, Lambda, ImageMagick), cutting costs by \$500/month and improving developer experience.
- Owned infrastructure and deployment automation as part of DevOps, contributing to platform stability while shipping API routes, bug fixes, and cron jobs across the core product.

Software Engineer — Shippable (acquired by JFrog) *Nov 2015 – Dec 2016*

- Built Docker-based deployment integrations (GKE, Amazon ECS, Docker Cloud) on the MEAN stack, automating CI/CD workflows for thousands of companies.
- Implemented PayPal's Braintree integration, streamlining payment processing across products.

Software Engineer — Altair Engineering *Feb 2014 – Nov 2015*

- Built REST APIs (Ruby/Sinatra) and optimized database calls for WEYV, a music-streaming app (Ruby, Angular, Node).

EDUCATION

B.E., Computer Science & Engineering *Jul 2010 – Jul 2014*

Manipal Institute of Technology, Manipal, India